



Northwood Police Department

Interview Transcript (Form S-942)

Case No.
9649-2a

Date filed:
March 19, 2024

Details

Interview: Dr. Daniel Keene

Date: 03 / 18 / 2024

Time: 8:15 am

Location: Riverside University -
Keen's office

Detective Jensen: Please state your name and occupation for the record.

Daniel Keen: Professor Daniel Keene. I'm the Head of Biochemistry at Riverside University.

Detective Jensen: And how did you know Dr. Eleanor Vance?

Daniel Keen: Everyone in our field knows Eleanor. Brilliant, methodical, frustratingly cautious. We met years ago at conferences, seminars, research symposiums. We've debated each other more times than I can count – some of them quite publicly. Heated, even.

Detective Jensen: You sound... conflicted.

Daniel Keen: Conflicted is a fair word. Look – I respect her. I do. Eleanor had this incredible mind. But she always managed to be the one people remembered. Every grant, every award, every article – her name was front and center. Meanwhile, my projects stalled.

Detective Jensen: We recovered an email you sent to Dr. Vance two weeks ago that reads, in part, "end her career one way or another." Can you explain that?

Dr. Daniel Keene: *[visibly uncomfortable]* Yes. I wrote that. I'm not proud of the wording. It was an angry, late-night message after yet another grant review where her name – and her work – were singled out. I was venting. It was rhetorical, not a plan. I used hyperbole I shouldn't have.

Detective Jensen: So you admit you sent it?

Dr. Daniel Keene: I do. I sent an email that expressed frustration. I have every right to be frustrated – my funding has dried up, my lab's reputation has suffered, and it often felt like Eleanor's success came at my expense. But writing a poorly chosen phrase in a moment of anger is not the same as plotting harm.

Detective Jensen: Did you ever say anything like that to colleagues in person? Any threats beyond the email?

Dr. Daniel Keene: No. My debates with Eleanor were blistering at times, but they were academic fights – pointed, public, often overheard at conferences. I've never threatened physical harm. Never. My anger is professional. I wanted recognition and funding back for my work, not to hurt anyone.

Detective Jensen: Where were you on the night of Eleanor's death?

Daniel Keen: Three hours away, on my way home from giving a presentation at Sciencefest. The Life of a Scientist. They wanted something inspiring, public-friendly. Don't get me wrong – I enjoy presenting. But that should have been my chance to present real science. My research. Instead, Eleanor was the one who got the prime slot – she was scheduled to give a major talk the very next afternoon about her enzyme work. Work that would've made headlines.

Detective Jensen: Did you ever see Eleanor in the lab before her death?

Daniel Keen: Briefly that morning. Renee Carter – her assistant – escorted me into the lab for a short visit. I asked if I could co-present with her. Thought it was a reasonable request – we'd debated enough, maybe it was time to stand together. She flat-out refused. Said it was her work and needed to stay that way. I was there maybe fifteen minutes, max. Then she showed me out. That was it.

Detective Jensen: And after that?

Daniel Keen: I left for Sciencefest. I gave my presentation and was on my way home at the time you say Eleanor died. Hundreds of people saw me. Check the program, the recordings.

Detective Jensen: One last question: despite your alibi, would you say you had motive?

Daniel Keen: [tightens jaw] Motive? Sure. I'll admit that. But opportunity? No. I was nowhere near her when it happened.

Conducted By: Det. Pat Jensen

Transcribed By: Shawn Nguyen



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Interview Transcript (Form S-942)

Case No.
9649-2a

Date filed:
March 15, 2024

Details

Interview: Renee Carter

Date:	03 / 15 / 2024	Time:	11:30 am	Location:	Northwood Research Institute RM C-104
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Detective Jensen: Please state your name for the record.

Renee Carter: Renee Marie Carter.

Detective Jensen: And your relationship to Dr. Eleanor Vance?

Renee Carter: I was her lab assistant. We worked together nearly every day. And... we also used to date. A couple years ago.

Detective Jensen: You're aware Dr. Vance had a current partner?

Renee Carter: Yes. Ann. [hesitates] I mean, I'm happy for her. Really. Eleanor deserves someone steady. But- [fidgets with her hands] I'd be lying if I said it doesn't sting a little. I always thought... maybe someday, we'd find our way back to each other.

Detective Jensen: So how did that work - working so close with a former girlfriend? I bet that was frustrating?

Renee Carter: It wasn't easy, but we mostly focused on work. Eleanor and I didn't talk about our personal lives. Made it a little bit easier to forget what could have been ...

Detective Jensen: Let's talk about the evidence. Your fingerprint was found on broken glassware at the scene. Can you explain that?

Renee Carter: Of course. I mean, that's not strange. I handled the jars all the time - organizing, refilling, logging inventory. It was part of my job. If you check the logs, I filled up some of the solutions earlier this week. Finding my prints in the lab is totally normal.

Detective Jensen: What time did you leave the lab on the night of Eleanor's death?

Renee Carter: Seven o'clock sharp. I remember because I had a dinner reservation with a friend. I didn't come back.

Detective Jensen: Are you sure about that? The security guard reported seeing your car in the lot at 10:15 p.m.

Renee Carter: [visibly tense] Oh... right. That. Okay, yes, I drove back later. But not to see Eleanor - I swear. I realized I'd left my notebook in the office. I thought I could just run in and grab it.

Detective Jensen: Did you enter the building?



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Date filed:
March 18, 2024

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Interview: Catherine Rowe

Date: 03 / 18 / 2024 Time: 11:35 am Location: Northwood Police Station RM 2

Detective Jensen: Please state your name and occupation for the record.

Catherine Rowe: Catherine Rowe. I'm a senior representative at SynBioCorp, a biotech firm.

Detective Jensen: And how did you know Dr. Eleanor Vance?

Catherine Rowe: Professionally. SynBioCorp backed part of her research. We believed she was the right scientist to help us develop applications from enzyme systems her lab was working on.

Detective Jensen: And how did that collaboration go?

Catherine Rowe: At first, smoothly. She was brilliant, no question about it. But she also had... principles. Sometimes to a fault. We had a contract on the table, multimillion-dollar value, and Eleanor blocked it. Said there were "ethical concerns" with how the results would be applied. That decision cost my company money – and me personally. I've been clawing my way up for years. One deal like that makes or breaks a career.

Detective Jensen: You sound upset about it.

Catherine Rowe: Of course I was upset. Furious, actually. I'm not going to sugarcoat it. Eleanor cost SynBioCorp profits, and she made me look ineffective in front of my board.

Detective Jensen: Let's talk about the night of Eleanor's death. Where were you?

Catherine Rowe: I drove into Northwood. My car was parked in the lot across the river from the Institute. I think it is called lot B.

Detective Jensen: That's very close to the lab. Why were you there?

Catherine Rowe: I was supposed to visit a friend who lives a few blocks from the parking lot. I went to their place, but they weren't home.

Detective Jensen: Did you go into the lab that night?

Catherine Rowe: No. Absolutely not. I didn't see Eleanor. I didn't step foot inside the Institute.

Detective Jensen: Catherine, you admit you were furious with her, your car was across the river from the lab, and your alibi – this friend you say you were visiting – didn't see you. That's a lot of coincidence.

Catherine Rowe: [pauses, exhales sharply] I know how it looks. But I swear to you, I didn't go near that lab. Being angry is not the same thing as killing someone. Eleanor's death doesn't benefit me — it makes everything worse. SynBioCorp has investigators crawling all over me now.

Detective Jensen: Understood.

Conducted By: Det. Pat Jensen

Transcribed By: Dusty Riverson

Renee Carter: No. My badge wouldn't let me in after hours. I sat there for a bit, got frustrated, and then drove home. I didn't see Eleanor. I didn't hurt her.

Detective Jensen: Why didn't you mention this before?

Renee Carter: Because I knew how it would look. Eleanor... me... my car there after hours. I panicked. But I'm telling you the truth now. I swear.

Detective Jensen: Hmmm. Where did you go after you left?

Renee Carter: I was frustrated for not being able to get my notebook and went straight home to bed.

Detective Jensen: Did anyone see you? Did you talk to anyone?

Renee Carter: No. Went straight home to where I live alone ... unfortunately ...

Conducted By: Det. Pat Jensen

Transcribed By: Shawn Nguyen



Northwood Police Department

Interview Transcript (Form S-942)

Case No.
9649-2a

Date filed:
March 18, 2024

Details

Interview: Dr. Marcus Adler

Date: 03 / 14 / 2024 Time: 3:51pm Location: Northwood Police Station RM 4

Detective Jensen: Please state your name for the record.

Marcus Adler: Marcus Jonathan Adler.

Detective Jensen: And your connection to Dr. Eleanor Vance?

Marcus Adler: Eleanor was my colleague. We worked side by side in the lab for... almost four years now. She was brilliant, no doubt about that. But we didn't always see eye-to-eye.

Detective Jensen: How so?

Marcus Adler: *[sighs]* Eleanor had this very... cautious, methodical style. She double-checked everything, triple-checked it sometimes. I mean, I get it — we're dealing with dangerous chemicals, but her pace... it slowed us down. I've got ideas, big projects, and I felt like she was holding me back. My career, too. It's frustrating when you're ready to push forward and your partner insists on crawling.

Detective Jensen: Did you ever argue about this?

Marcus Adler: Not shouting matches, no. But yeah, we had words. I thought she was too strict, too controlling. You couldn't move a single jar without her snapping at you. She had this rule — every chemical had its exact place on the shelf. She'd say it was for safety, so nothing got knocked over or mislabeled. And... she wasn't wrong. But it felt obsessive sometimes.

Detective Jensen: Tell me about the night of Eleanor's death.

Marcus Adler: I was in the lab with her earlier that evening. We both stayed late to prep samples. But I left at 8:45. I'm sure of that — I checked the clock on my way out.

Detective Jensen: And where did you go?

Marcus Adler: I didn't go home, if that's what you're asking. I left my car in the lab parking lot and went for a long walk along the river. Needed to clear my head after another... tense evening. I was gone for hours. Just walking.

Detective Jensen: Anyone see you during this walk?

Marcus Adler: No. Not that I know of. It was quiet. Hardly anyone out there at that hour.

Detective Jensen: So, to be clear — you and Dr. Vance disagreed often, and you felt her approach was limiting your research and your professional advancement?



Northwood Police Department

Interview Transcript (Form S-942)

Case No.
9649-2a

Date filed:
March 18, 2024

Details

Interview: Margaret Vance

Date: 03 / 15 / 2024 Time: 1:15 pm Location: Margaret Vance's Home

Detective Harris: For the record, please state your name and relation to the deceased.

Margaret Vance: My name is Margaret Elaine Vance. Eleanor was my sister.

Detective Harris: Were the two of you close?

Margaret Vance: [sighs] We used to be. Years ago, we were inseparable. I even worked alongside her in the lab for a while. Back then, it felt like we were building something together. But when we had a breakthrough—something that could've defined both our careers—I left. I wanted to find my own way, prove myself outside of her shadow. After that, things... changed. We spoke less. She moved on with her research. I moved on with my life.

Detective Harris: Where are you working now?

Margaret Vance: Nowhere... I have a serious health condition—my doctors told me I had to stop working a few years ago. Since then... the bills have piled up. I've fallen behind. I'm worried about losing my house. It's... it's crushing.

Detective Harris: Did you ever ask Eleanor for help?

Margaret Vance: [hesitates] Yes. I did. I hated asking, but she's my sister. I thought she would understand. I told her I just needed enough money to cover the mortgage until I could sort things out. But she refused. Said she was saving to buy a proper home for herself and Ann. Can you imagine? Her girlfriend was more important than her own family. Who does that? Who turns their back on their own sister?

Detective Harris: That must have been hard to hear.

Margaret Vance: Hard? It was infuriating. I was desperate. And she... she brushed me aside like I was nothing.

Detective Harris: Did you see Eleanor the night of her death?

Margaret Vance: [pauses] Yes. She came over for dinner. It had been a long time since we'd done that. For a while, it almost felt like old times. But during the meal, she stepped outside to take a phone call. She left her bag sitting on a chair — her notes, computer, extra security badge, etc. I remember glancing at it. Just for a second. And I felt this... ache. It made me miss the lab. The work. The life I used to have.

Detective Harris: Where were you after she left?

Margaret Vance: At home. I didn't go anywhere.

Detective Harris: We have a neighbor's statement that says they saw you leaving your house late that evening. How do you explain that?

Margaret Vance: That's impossible. They must've been mistaken. I was home. And besides—I'm too ill to drive anywhere at night. I can barely manage errands during the day. There's no way I could've gone out.

Detective Harris: Yet your neighbor insists it was you.

Margaret Vance: [shakes head] They're wrong. They have to be. I didn't leave my house. I couldn't have.

Detective Harris: Is there anyone who can confirm you stayed home?

Margaret Vance: No... I was alone.

Conducted By: Det. Jean Harris

Transcribed By: Taylor Smith

Marcus Adler: *[tightens jaw]* Yes. But that doesn't mean I wanted her dead.

Conducted By: Det. Pat Jensen

Transcribed By: Shawn Nguyen